Click Optimization & Workflow Efficiency Guide

NurseBridge Optimization Lab – Scenario 1

Purpose

This guide helps identify excessive clicks in EHR workflows and provides practical strategies to reduce documentation burden while maintaining safety and accuracy.

What is Click Burden?

Click burden occurs when users must perform too many actions to complete a simple task. This leads to frustration, fatigue, and inefficiency.

Step 1: Observe the Workflow

1. Count number of clicks required
2. Track screen navigation
3. Identify repeated steps
4. Watch real user behavior

Example 1: Medication Documentation

Before Optimization: Nurse opens MAR, clicks into medication, navigates back and forth between tabs, then documents.

After Optimization: Required information is visible in one view, reducing clicks and navigation.

Step 2: Identify Inefficiencies

1. Duplicate data entry
2. Unnecessary navigation
3. Hidden key information
4. Too many clicks per task

Example 2: Flowsheet Documentation

Before Optimization: Nurse scrolls through long flowsheets to find fields.

After Optimization: Frequently used rows moved to top for quick access.

Step 3: Recommend Improvements

1. Use default settings

2. Reduce unnecessary fields
3. Group related items together
4. Introduce shortcuts or templates

Example 3: Notes Documentation

Before Optimization: Nurse types repetitive phrases manually.

After Optimization: Smart phrases reduce typing and improve efficiency.

Step 4: Validate the Change

1. Does it reduce clicks?
2. Does it save time?
3. Does it maintain safety?
4. Is it easy to learn?

Common Mistakes

1. Reducing clicks but creating confusion
2. Ignoring real user workflow
3. Overcomplicating optimization
4. Removing necessary safety checks

Final Reminder

Optimization is not just about fewer clicks—it is about smarter workflows that improve efficiency without compromising patient safety.